

1. The message SHALL be of **Group Session Type**, otherwise discard the message.
2. If **C Flag** is set to **1**:
 - a. Create a **Message Reception State** and set its **max_message_counter** to the message counter of the given message, i.e. **trust-first**.
 - b. Accept the message for further processing.
3. If **C Flag** is set to **0**:
 - a. Determine the **GroupKeySecurityPolicy** (as set by the **Section 11.2, “Group Key Management Cluster”**) of the operational group key used to authenticate the message.
 - b. If the key has a *trust-first* security policy, the receiver SHALL:
 - i. Set the peer’s group key data message counter to *Message Counter* of the message.
 - A. Clear the **Message Reception State** bitmap for the group session from the peer.
 - B. Mark the peer 's group key data message counter as synchronized.
 - ii. Process the message.
 - c. If the key has a *cache-and-sync* security policy, the receiver SHALL:
 - i. If MCSP is not in progress for the given peer Node ID and group key:
 - A. Store the message for later processing.
 - B. Proceed to **Section 4.18.5, “Message Counter Synchronization Exchange”**.
 - ii. Otherwise, do not process the message.
 - A. An implementation MAY queue the message for later processing after MCSP completes if resources allow.

For each peer Node ID and group key pair there SHALL be at most one synchronization exchange outstanding at a time.

4.18.5. Message Counter Synchronization Exchange

A message synchronization exchange starts by sending the **MsgCounterSyncReq** message to the peer Node that sent the message with unknown message counter. When a synchronization request is triggered by an incoming multicast message, the Node SHALL first wait for a uniformly **random** amount of time between **0** and **MSG_COUNTER_SYNC_REQ_JITTER**.

The sender of the *MsgCounterSyncReq* message SHALL:

1. Set the Message Header fields as follows:
 - a. The **S Flag** SHALL be set to **1**.
 - b. The **DSIZ** field SHALL be set to **1**.
 - c. The **P Flag** SHALL be set to **1**.
 - d. The **C Flag** SHALL be set to **1**.
 - e. The **Session Type** field SHALL be set to **1**.
 - f. The **Session ID** field SHALL be set to the **Group Session Id** for the operational group key